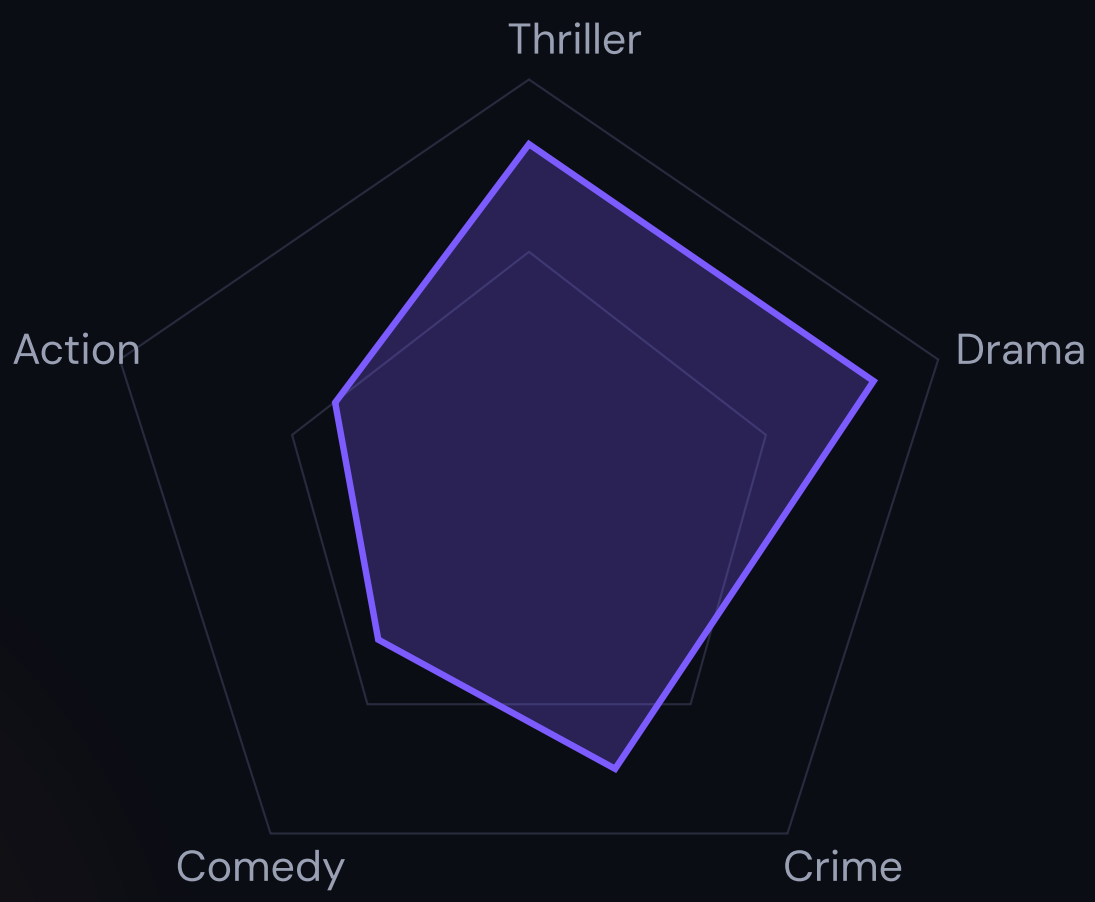
BLIND SPOT · AI PRODUCT CASE STUDY

80% of what you watch on Netflix comes from its recommendations.

Here's what it's hiding from you.



The numbers that made me build this

325M+

Netflix subscribers worldwide (Q4 2025)

80%

of what members watch comes from Netflix's recommendations

$20B

2026 content budget — all surfaced through the algorithm

Even the posters

the thumbnail artwork is personalized to your profile

Netflix's own reported figures — the algorithm doesn't just rank titles, it shapes the images you see.

Optimizing for engagement means optimizing for familiarity.

A recommender that keeps you watching learns to show you more of what you already like. The second-order effect is a taste bubble you can't see from the inside.

It ranks

~80% of viewing starts from a recommendation, not a search.

It re-skins

Netflix personalizes the thumbnail artwork itself to match your taste.

It narrows

The more you watch, the tighter the funnel of what you're shown.

Eli Pariser named the "filter bubble" (2011); researchers have since probed Netflix's recommender directly (Pajkovic, 2022). The effect is debated — which is exactly why letting people see their own patterns is useful.

Everyone builds a better recommender. Nobody shows you the bubble.

Taste.io	"More of what you like" → same direction
Letterboxd	Track & discover films → social, no blind-spot analysis
Diversity research	Academic re-ranking for serendipity → a paper, not a product

Zero products optimize for showing you what you're missing.

Blind Spot: see your bubble, score it, break it.

Import → Reveal → Confront → Bridge → Act

Bubble Score

A single 0–100 number for how narrow your taste is — with a plain breakdown of why.

Blind spots

The genres you avoid, ranked by what's actually worth your time on Netflix.

Bridges

An LLM reasons why a film from a genre you skip fits what you already love.

Input is a one-file Netflix export, parsed entirely in the browser — nothing is uploaded.

The AI, scoped honestly

Not everything here is "AI." Knowing which part is — and defending it — is the point.

LLM features

Bridge reasoning (the core generative surface) and the one-line taste summary. Both run server-side with deterministic fallbacks.

Classical ML / stats

Content-based filtering (genre & keyword vectors), cosine-similarity ranking, Herfindahl concentration, the Bubble Score.

Rejected

Collaborative filtering (no user base yet — honest), and AI "mood detection" (unreliable, unmeasurable).

MEASURING THE CORE AI FEATURE

I evaluated my own AI feature.

A 21-case golden set and an LLM-as-judge scoring the bridge on groundedness, relevance, and specificity — naive prompt (v1) vs production (v2).

Metric	v1 naive	v2 production
Groundedness (1–5)	4.67	**4.88**
Relevance (1–5)	4.43	**4.94**
Hallucination rate	5%	**0%**
Refuse accuracy	0%	**100%**

It caught a real production bug (refusals leaking to users) and a metric I'd calibrated wrong. Both fixes came from reading the per-case table — not the summary.

Technical decisions & trade-offs

Upload, not "connect"

Netflix has no public API. User-exported CSV, parsed client-side — legitimate and private.

Keys server-side

A browser-shipped key is an exposed key. TMDB & LLM calls proxy through serverless functions.

Own palette, not Netflix red

The product is about leaving the bubble. Wearing Netflix's colors implies affiliation.

Cosine over Euclidean

Measures direction ("what kind"), not magnitude — the right call for sparse taste vectors.

Measured, not guessed.

4.88/5
bridge groundedness (eval)

0%
hallucination rate (eval)

100%
honest-refusal accuracy (eval)

Instrumented funnel (PostHog)

Screen views, CSV import, sample runs, shares, and watchlist saves — so activation, share rate, and day-3 retention are read from data, not assumed. Wired before launch.

Grounded in published research

Pariser (2011)	"The Filter Bubble" — named the problem
Pajkovic (2022)	Convergence / SAGE — probing Netflix's recommender logics
Systematic review (2023)	"Filter bubbles: fact or fallacy" — the effect is still debated

The effect is documented *and* contested. Blind Spot's value — transparency into your own patterns — holds either way.

What I'd build next

Personalize the bridges

Weight candidates harder on the user's own theme vector — and measure the lift with the existing eval.

Eval in CI

Run the golden set on every prompt change; grow it into a real regression suite.

Optional accounts

Cross-device watchlist — offered after the aha moment, never gating the funnel.

Multi-platform

The same bubble analysis for Spotify listening and Prime history.

Shipped a complete, measured product over a perfect spec.

Netflix is optimized to keep you watching.

Blind Spot is optimized to help you grow.

Research-driven product thinking. AI applied where it matters — and measured. Shipped full-stack.

TRY BLIND SPOT

my-blind-spot.vercel.app

Built by Aashi Thakkar

Code: github.com/aashi2912/blind-spot